

TRAINING SCHEDULE

Module 1: Transforming Maps into Stories

Objective: Build skills for developing interactive web maps, dashboards and create story maps.

Session & Dates	Topic	Content Description
1 10/08/2026	Introduction to ArcGIS Online for conservation	Introduction to Geospatial tools for Biodiversity Conservation. - Geospatial tools for biodiversity conservation. - Overview of the ArcGIS Online Platform. - Accessing the ArcGIS Online interface using your assigned training account.
2 11/08/2026	Building interactive Web Maps.	- Introduction to web maps. - Creating Protected and Conserved Areas web maps. - Adding and Managing Data: <i>Fetching data from various sources:</i> Downloading and Uploading files (shapefiles, geodatabase, CSV, etc.), and connecting to geoportals like the RCoE Geoportal. <i>Layer Management:</i> Adding layers from URLs, renaming layers for clarity, and referencing files directly from URLs without creating hosted feature layers. <i>Exploring Collaborative Content:</i> Utilizing shared content, including favorites, organizational groups, and the ArcGIS Living Atlas.
3 12/08/2026	Designing real-time Dashboards for data visualization	- Dashboard Concepts & Principles. Understanding the role of dashboards in conservation monitoring and how to transform static spatial data into dynamic, real-time decision support tools. - Layout Configuration: Building responsive layouts using headers, side panels, and flexible grid arrangements to optimize user experience. - Data Visualization Elements: Configuring key visual elements to represent environmental metrics, including: <i>Charts:</i> Setting up serial, pie, and bar charts for data trends.

Session & Dates	Topic	Content Description
		○ <i>Indicators & Gauges</i>: Visualizing key performance indicators (KPIs) such as total area protected or percentage of habitat restored. ○ <i>Lists & Details</i>: Creating summary lists for easy data navigation. • Map Integration: Embedding interactive Web Maps to provide spatial context and real-time geography within the dashboard view. • Interactivity & User Experience: Implementing category selectors, map extents, and filters that allow stakeholders to drill down into specific data segments dynamically. • Publishing & Sharing: Configuring access levels, mobile responsiveness, and embedding the final dashboard into broader reports or ArcGIS StoryMaps.
4 13/08/2026	Crafting immersive narratives with ArcGIS Story Maps.	• Storytelling Fundamentals: Understanding the narrative arc, audience engagement, and how to combine spatial data with non-spatial multimedia to communicate conservation impacts effectively. • The ArcGIS StoryMaps Builder Interface: Navigating the builder tool, managing content blocks (text, buttons, separators, quotes), and configuring design themes (colors, typography, and cover layouts). • Integrating Multimedia & Dynamic Content: ○ Embedding interactive elements: Adding live Web Maps, scene views, and dashboards directly into the story flow. ○ Multimedia implementation: Optimizing images, videos, audio clips, and sidecars to enhance visual storytelling. • Narrative Layout Techniques: ○ Sidecars: Mastering scrollable experiences where the map updates as the reader scrolls. ○ Guided Maps: Using the map tour and map series blocks to lead the reader through a sequence of locations. ○ Swipe/Comparison: Configuring swipe blocks to compare historical vs. current land-use changes or "before/after" conservation scenarios. • Accessibility & Publication: Optimizing stories for different screen sizes (mobile vs. desktop), ensuring alt-text for images/maps, setting sharing permissions, and publishing the final narrative to ArcGIS Online.

Module 2: Transforming Data into Decisions

Objective: Generate spatial insights and decision support using GeoHex.

Session & Dates	Topic	Content Description
1 17/08/2026	Introduction to GeoHex	- Introduction to Hexagonal Gridding: <i>Understanding</i> the advantages of hexagonal binning over traditional grids (e.g., reduced edge distortion, better distance consistency). - Why GeoHex is effective for standardizing disparate conservation datasets. - The GeoHex Workflow: - The end-to-end process: Defining grid scales, assigning locations to hexagonal cells, and managing spatial resolutions for different geographic scopes. - Integration with ArcGIS Online: Practical steps for generating and visualizing GeoHex grids within your existing workspace.
2 18/08/2026	Spatial Data Aggregation	Techniques for summarizing complex ecological data (species occurrence and protected area coverage) into hexagonal units.
3 19/08/2026	Decision Support & Conservation Planning:	Hotspot Analysis: Identifying high-priority areas for conservation through density-based visualization. Gap Analysis: Utilizing GeoHex to identify spatial "blind spots" in conservation coverage to support the implementation of GBF Target 3.
4 20/08/2026	Visualizing Insights	Translating aggregated hexagonal data into clear, decision-ready maps.